

Build Brief — Week 01 Polish Pass (10/10)

Paste into Claude Code in the engine repo, on a new branch `week-01-big-footprint-polish` from the release build.

We're doing a polish pass on this week's Retroment Gaming text adventure, "This Place Has a Big Footprint." The game already works and ships. This pass adds depth only: descriptions for every noun, text that follows game state, replies for more verbs, character lines, hint ladders, and varied endings. Before writing code, read the current build, its add-ons (`verbs` , `messages` , `restart`), the `SCENERY` table and the tests, and follow those patterns instead of inventing new ones.

Source of truth

- **GDD:** `GDD_week01_rev3.md` . Section 12 is new; everything else matches rev 2.
- **Script:** `SCRIPT_week01_rev2.txt` (unchanged text) **plus** `SCRIPT_week01_rev3_additions.txt`

(all new text, keyed by ID).

- **Plan:** "This Place Has a Big Footprint: 10/10 Polish Plan" (the why; the GDD and Script are the what).

If the GDD and Script disagree, the GDD wins. Flag the conflict; don't silently pick.

Hard rules

- **Nothing moves.** Rooms, exits, items, puzzles, solutions, win and lose rules, and clock values stay exactly as rev 2. The only rule changes are GDD 12.1 D1-D3 and the two accepted-answer additions in 12.6.
- **The existing 24 tests must pass without edits** after every milestone. If one fails, the change is wrong, not the test.
- **Conditions come from GDD 12.4 only.** If a Script line needs a condition that isn't in that table, stop and ask.
- **Text lives in data** (the **T** table and the add-on tables), never in engine code.
- **Use Script text as written.** Don't reword. If a line doesn't fit the engine, flag it.
- No new rooms, items, NPCs, puzzles, endings, commands beyond GDD 12.3, or features.

Build in three milestones

Stop after each one, tell me how to test it, and wait for my "go".

Milestone A – Coverage

- Every [X.*] noun in Script section A is examinable with its WORDS, in the phases its entry lists. Entries marked REPLACES swap out the rev 2 scenery or item line.
- Room nouns are matched before item names (Script C4), so "place card" never finds the BRIEFING CARD.
- New verbs and synonyms from GDD 12.3 parse. "look under / behind / in X" means search.
- search, smell, listen are free (D2). Strike verbs on strike objects during TOUR add a strike (D1).
- The reply ladder from GDD 12.3 works, with the Script C1 category defaults and C2 global replies.
- The adjacent-room examine rule (Script B, [ROOM.adjacent]).
- **New test: coverage.** For every room, in TOUR (where reachable) and in ESCAPE: examine every WORDS entry of every noun visible in that phase, and try every Tier 1 verb on it. Fail if any reply is a confused line or "Nothing like that around here."

Build the noun list from the data, not by hand, so the test grows with the Script.

- **Test for me:** the coverage test passes, the 24 old tests pass, and I can x lemur , smell humidor and look under table with in-voice replies.

Milestone B – State

- IF lines on nouns, using the 12.4 keys (the last true IF wins).
- Room tails, escape revisits, foyer PASS lines, leg cues, checkpoint foreshadowing, and Nando's traces (Script B).
- The R8 first-visit and revisit text with chlorine, and the three-paragraph R11 arrival.
- Big Tony's clock-band lines by room type, alternating two versions per cell.
- Turn feedback lines (Script C3), ESCAPE only, never the same one twice in a row.
- The Don's per-stop examine and talk lines, ask-about topics with strike tiers, reactions (once each), and social verbs (Script D1-D3).
- Nando's greetings, repeat lines (free at a checkpoint, D3), and CAUGHT openers (Script D4).
- New state keys STRIKE3_BY and CAUGHT_BY are recorded.
- **New tests:** one per state key that changes text (for example: release the giraffe, then x

banister shows her head; solve P2, then x hippo shows the open jaw; talk to Nando at a checkpoint, then confirm the checkpoint is still open and the clock didn't move).

- **Test for me:** play the W1 route and read every room. Everything I did should show.

Milestone C — Feel

- Hint ladders (Script E1), each ladder keeping its own place.
- Graded wrong attempts (E2) and secret close-ups on first look (E3).
- Alibi and run lines per checkpoint (E4).
- Ending variants (F1), the run report (F2) with "Things examined: X of Y" counted from data, and the rotating after-ending lines (F3).
- **New tests:** one per ending variant, plus a run report check (secrets, turns to spare and strikes match the run).
- **Test for me:** reach every ending and read its report.

After each milestone, give me

- What you built, and the exact commands to test it.
- Anything you weren't sure about, and any Script line you couldn't place.

- The test count: old tests (must be 24 passing) plus new ones.
- A commit: "Polish A: coverage", "Polish B: state", "Polish C: feel".

Regression, every milestone

Run the verified walkthrough

(`WALKTHROUGH_week01.txt`). It must win with 7 turns to spare, and the W2 branch with 4, with identical clock values at every step. Text may differ; numbers may not.